of distinct but similar entities" in a broadest sense, and in a narrow sense, as " the legal condition which equally permits two or more hostile groups to carry on a conflict by armed forces". He further suggested the possible causes of war in his *Causes of War and Conditions of Peace* (1935) as being in a sense the obverse of the conditions of peace which are related to the following aspects of the world situation:

- A state of opinion violently hostile to the existing state of affairs
- Inadequacy of international organization to deal with conflicts
- Inadequate system of law
- Unstable equilibrium of material forces.

Wright points out that there can also be politico-technological, juro-ideological, socio-religious, and psycho-economic causes of war.

However, the role of military power as an instrument of national policy is often considered in a political rather than in a purely military context. The validity of Clausewitz's strictures against a rigid compartmentalization of politics and military strategy turns out to be more true, especially in the present context when advances in military technologies have transformed war from a diversion of monarchs to a potential menace against humanity. In the nuclear age particularly military forces exist not solely for the purpose of inflicting damage on enemies but also as a threat to gain leverage in diplomatic bargaining or as a means of communicating one's intentions to potential adversaries.

Force and threat of use of force have existed in international relations and development of military technologies has an important impact on the structures and processes of political systems. Thermonuclear weapons and long-range ballistics missiles are qualitatively different from their predecessors or conventional forces. Long range missiles such as intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs), and short-range ballistic missiles (SRBMs) have come to constitute major strategic delivery vehicles which carry a warhead up along a trajectory and let it drop on the target. Military analysts